Carboplatin AUC 2 with radiotherapy

Carboplatin and radiotherapy are used together as part of the treatment plan for head and neck cancer. The team explains the treatment aim, expected benefit and why this medicine and schedule suit your situation.

Head and neck cancer: weekly chemoradiation · NCCP 00419 v6 · Document revised 10 November 2026

Your personal plan: this is the standard regimen schedule. Your team confirms your prescribed doses, cycles, treatment changes and appointments in your written plan.

This guide covers NCCP 00419 for head and neck cancer. It does not prescribe the radiation dose or number of radiation sessions. The 6 planned weekly carboplatin doses are a separate count. Any earlier or later chemotherapy needs its own plan.

My overall treatment

Once every 7 days for 6 planned weekly doses, during radiotherapy.



Preparation	Concurrent treatment	Recovery
The team confirms readiness, kidney-based dosing and the radiation calendar.	6 weekly carboplatin doses are planned during radiation; dose and session counts are separate.	Support and response review continue after treatment. Further treatment requires a separate plan.

A typical 7-day cycle

Day 1	Day 2–7
Weekly medicine visit	Radiation appointments and symptom care

Timing may change after review. Side effects can occur on any day; there are no guaranteed safe days.

My tests and checks

When	What is checked	Timing / reason
Before	**Bloods and kidney assessment** NCCP / radiation plan	Blood count, kidney/liver tests and measured or estimated kidney filtration; dental, nutrition and swallowing preparation.
During	**Checks before every weekly dose** NCCP / radiation plan	Blood count and kidney/liver tests; review mouth, skin, weight, drinking, swallowing and radiation attendance.
After / response	**Recovery and assessment** Individual plan	Continue symptom and late-effect care; examinations and scans follow your individual plan.

Between treatments

- Radiation appointments follow their own calendar. If a session changes, contact both teams before the next carboplatin dose.
- Symptoms may build up and persist after treatment. Report fever, sudden illness, bleeding or inability to drink promptly.

Bring your medicines, blood-test dates, radiation calendar and verified urgent contacts.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.

What to watch for

You do not need to know which medicine caused a symptom before calling.

1 Mouth, saliva and teeth
Head and neck radiotherapy

Soreness (mucositis), dry mouth and taste change may affect intake. Dental risk may persist; keep the oral-care and dental plan.

2 Throat, voice and swallowing
Head and neck radiotherapy

Pain or difficulty swallowing can build up and may last. Report choking, food sticking or inability to drink; ask for swallowing support.

3 Skin in the radiation area
Radiotherapy

Redness, soreness or skin breakdown may occur in the treated area. Use the radiation team's skin-care plan and report worsening pain.

4 Blood and infection
Carboplatin

Low white cells can cause serious infection; low platelets can cause bleeding; anaemia can cause fatigue. Fever, sudden illness or unusual bleeding needs urgent contact.

5 Stomach and intake
Carboplatin + radiation effects

Nausea, vomiting and poor intake can cause dehydration. Take prescribed anti-sickness medicines and call if you cannot drink.

6 Kidneys and fluid balance
Carboplatin

Kidney function determines the dose. Report reduced urine, vomiting or poor intake; do not calculate or change the dose yourself.

7 Hearing and ears
Platinum chemotherapy

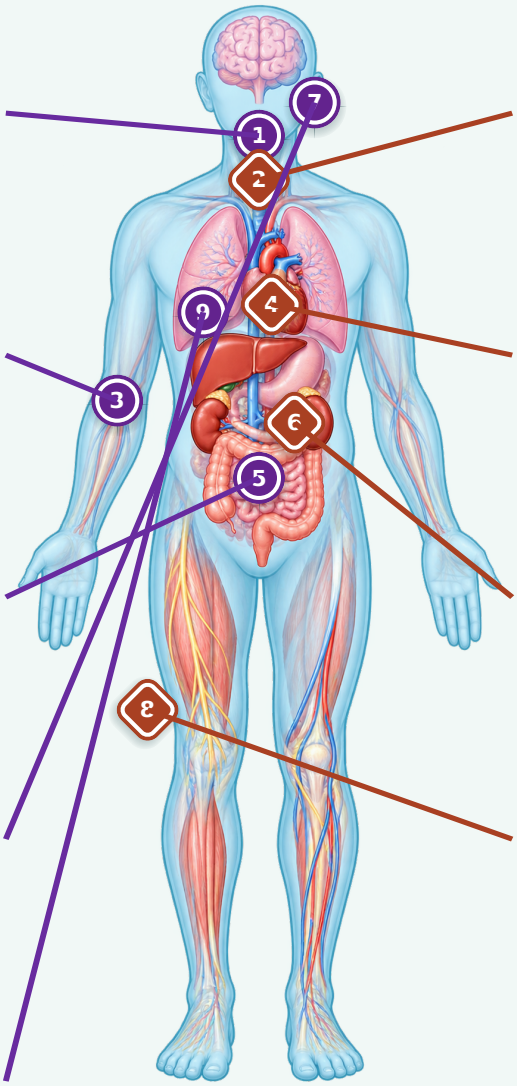
Hearing change or ringing may be new or persist from earlier treatment. Report it before the next dose.

8 Hands, feet and nerves
Platinum chemotherapy

Numbness or tingling (peripheral neuropathy) may affect walking or fine tasks. Report changes and any earlier persistent symptoms.

9 Whole-body infusion reaction
Carboplatin

Rash, flushing, chest tightness, breathing difficulty or faintness may signal an allergic reaction. Tell infusion staff immediately.



Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Call oncology immediately for fever, shivering, sudden illness, unusual bruising or bleeding, persistent vomiting, severe mouth or throat pain, inability to drink or much less urine. Report new hearing changes, numbness, worsening swallowing, choking or skin breakdown promptly. During an infusion, tell staff immediately about rash, flushing, chest tightness, breathing difficulty or faintness. Severe chest pain, severe breathing difficulty, collapse or a seizure is an emergency: call 112 or 999.

When to get help

Call 112 / 999 for severe breathing difficulty, severe chest pain, collapse or a seizure.

Call oncology immediately: temperature 37.5°C or above, 36°C or below, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your hospital's temperature instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment. Do not wait for the next appointment.

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Keep your treatment details to hand

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Print this page **one-sided on A4 at Actual size / 100%**. Cut only the dashed outer border around both panels. **Do not cut the centre line.** Fold with FRONT and BACK facing out, then glue or tape the blank backs together. Finished size: **85.6 × 54 mm**. Keep the stamp side writable.

FRONT / CONTACTS

My Treatment Card

SACTCheck

Name: _____

Carboplatin AUC 2 + radiotherapy

Weekly × 6, concurrent with radiotherapy (RT)

Phase: _____ Planned cycles: 6

Daytime (EXAMPLE) 087 12345678

Out of hours (EXAMPLE) 087 87654321

Unwell or fever? Call oncology now.
Severe breathing difficulty, chest pain or collapse: **112 / 999.**

EXAMPLE NUMBERS — replace before patient use.

BACK / TREATMENT RECORD

My cycle record

Team stamps after each completed cycle.

C1	C2	C3
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials
C4	C5	C6
Date / initials	Date / initials	Date / initials

My treatment information

Plan changed? Ask the team to update this card.

CUT outer border

FOLD centre — do not cut

Keep the record accurate

The team dates and initials each recorded treatment unit when complete. A cycle is complete after its final planned dose; a weekly-treatment stamp records that weekly dose. Delays, omitted doses or a changed plan need a note or a replacement card. A stamp does not approve the next treatment. Keep any medicine-specific alert card too.

Put your treatment page on your phone

Scan your QR and check the treatment name. Save that page to your home screen.

iPhone / Safari

Tap Share → Add to Home Screen. Select Open as Web App if offered, then Add.

Android / Chrome

Tap the three-dot menu → Add to Home screen or Install and create shortcut. Choose the shortcut option and confirm.

Menu wording varies. The QR opens information, not a personal record. Paper stamps do not update the website. Check that the saved icon opens the correct treatment.

Your local contacts and resources

Oncology daytime: 087 12345678 · **Out of hours:** 087 87654321

EXAMPLE ONLY — team must replace both numbers before patient use.

Hospital / team: _____

Backup if the team cannot be reached: _____

Additional local services and resources will be added when confirmed. Your team must check and complete this page before patient use.

Feasibility build. Clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Your team confirms your personal plan.